

IELTS Essay Question Types & How to Answer

There are **5 main types** of Task 2 essay questions:

1. Opinion (Agree or Disagree)

◆ Question Example:

Do you agree or disagree with the statement: "It is better to learn from experience than from books."

✅ Structure:

- Introduction (Paraphrase + Thesis Statement)
- Body 1: Reason 1
- Body 2: Reason 2
- Conclusion

 **Tip:** Choose one clear side and support it with strong reasons.

2. Discussion (Discuss Both Views + Your Opinion)

◆ Question Example:

Some believe that university education should be free. Others think students should pay tuition. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

✅ Structure:

- Introduction
- Body 1: View A
- Body 2: View B
- Body 3: Your opinion
- Conclusion

 **Tip:** Be balanced. Present both views fairly and clearly show *your stance*.

3. Problem/Solution

◆ Question Example:

Traffic congestion is becoming a huge problem in urban areas. What are the causes? What solutions can you suggest?

✅ **Structure:**

- Introduction
- Body 1: Problems/Causes
- Body 2: Solutions
- Conclusion

🔑 **Tip:** Use real-world examples and don't mix up problems with solutions in one paragraph.

4. Advantages and Disadvantages

◆ **Question Example:**

What are the advantages and disadvantages of working from home?

✅ **Structure:**

- Introduction
- Body 1: Advantages
- Body 2: Disadvantages
- Conclusion (You may state your opinion if asked)

🔑 **Tip:** Keep balance, don't make it one-sided unless the question says "Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?"

5. Double Question (Direct Questions)

◆ **Question Example:**

Many people buy imported goods. Why is this the case? Is it a positive or negative development?

✅ **Structure:**

- Introduction
- Body 1: Answer question 1
- Body 2: Answer question 2

- Conclusion

 **Tip:** Answer both parts equally and clearly. Avoid blending the answers.

Extra Tips for Band 7.0–9.0

- Use **specific examples** (e.g., "In countries like Japan..." instead of "In many countries...")
- Always **plan** your essay for 5–7 minutes before writing
- Practice writing within 40 minutes to manage your time

IELTS Writing Task 2 – RULES TO FOLLOW

1. **Time Limit:** 40 minutes
2. **Word Count:** Minimum **250 words** (ideal: 260–280)
3. **Structure:** Use **4–5 paragraphs**:
 - Introduction
 - Body Paragraph 1
 - Body Paragraph 2
 - (Optional Body Paragraph 3)
 - Conclusion
4. **Avoid:**
 - Contractions (e.g., *don't*, *can't*) – use *do not*, *cannot*
 - Informal language or slang
 - Repetition or off-topic content
 - Memorized answers
5. **Use Linking Words** (cohesive devices):
 - **Addition:** Furthermore, Moreover, In addition
 - **Contrast:** However, On the other hand, Although

- **Examples:** For instance, Such as, Namely
- **Cause/Effect:** Because, Therefore, As a result

6. Grammar and Vocabulary:

- Use a mix of simple and complex sentences
- Aim for topic-specific vocabulary
- Check verb tenses and subject-verb agreement

7. Task Response:

- **Fully address all parts** of the question
- Present a **clear opinion**, when required
- Stay **on topic**

■ IELTS Reading Overview

- **Duration:** 60 minutes (no extra time for transfer)
 - **40 questions**, 3 passages
 - **Types:**
 - **Academic** (for university/immigration)
 - **General Training** (for work/migration)
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✓ Top IELTS Reading Tips

1. Skim First, Then Scan

- **Skim** = read quickly to understand the main idea of each paragraph.
 - **Scan** = look for specific information, names, dates, keywords.
 - ◆ **How:** Read the **title**, **subheadings**, and the **first sentence** of each paragraph.
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2. Don't Read Every Word

- IELTS Reading is about **strategy**, not full comprehension.
 - Focus on **questions** and locate answers using **keywords**.
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3. Underline or Highlight Keywords

- When reading questions, underline **names, numbers, nouns, adjectives**.
 - Use them to quickly **locate information** in the passage.
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4. Paraphrasing is Key

- IELTS often **rephrases** questions using synonyms.
 - Practice spotting paraphrases like:
 - *"Increase in crime" = "rise in offenses"*
 - *"Children" = "youngsters"*
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5. Watch for Traps

- Especially in **True/False/Not Given** or **Yes/No/Not Given**:
 - **True/Yes**: Info matches the passage exactly.
 - **False/No**: Contradicted by the passage.
 - **Not Given**: The passage doesn't say either way.

● **Tip**: If you're not sure, it's probably "Not Given." Don't assume.

6. Follow Question Order

- Questions generally follow the order of the passage. Answer them in sequence to save time.
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7. Improve Reading Speed

- Use sites like:
 - <https://readtheory.org/>
 - <https://newsela.com/>
 - Practice reading **news articles** from:
 - BBC, The Guardian, National Geographic, Scientific American
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8. Write EXACTLY What's Required

- **For completion questions**:
 - If it says "**NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS**", writing three = **wrong**.
 - Always **check spelling** and **copy exactly** from the passage.
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9. Time Management

- Spend **20 minutes per passage**
 - Skimming: 2–3 minutes
 - Answering: 15 minutes
 - Checking: 2–3 minutes

10. Practice with Real Tests

Use past papers from:

- **Cambridge IELTS Books (1–18)**
- [IELTS Online Tests](#)
- [Mini IELTS](#)
- IELTS Liz

 Don't get stuck on one question—move on and come back if needed.

Common Question Types (Learn the Strategy for Each)

1.  **Matching Headings**
2.  **True/False/Not Given**
3.  **Multiple Choice**
4.  **Sentence/Note/Table Completion**
5.  **Matching Names to Statements**
6.  **Summary Completion**